

FL.4 Where to File Directory

Which government has your parcel, which office comes first, and a page to record what you confirmed.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Florida is the opposite of a no-permit state: one building code binds every parcel in all 67 counties, every jurisdiction permits and inspects, and a local government may not simply write its own residential code. What still varies is the part that costs you money and weeks — fees, impact fees, review queues, portals, and which *additional* permits your particular lot triggers before the building department will act. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

FIRST: WHICH GOVERNMENT IS ACTUALLY YOURS?

Florida has 67 counties and more than 400 municipalities, and a great many cities run their own building departments entirely separately from the surrounding county. A parcel with an Orlando mailing address may be permitted by the City of Orlando, or by Orange County, and the mailing address will not tell you which. The construction lien statute assumes this: it applies to “every municipality and county in the state which now has or hereafter may have a system of issuing building permits” (s. 713.135(8), Fla. Stat.).

The reliable way to settle it

Look your parcel up on the **county property appraiser's** parcel search. Every Florida county has one, it is free, and the record shows the parcel's taxing authorities and whether it sits inside a municipality. That answer — not the mailing address, not the ZIP code — tells you whose building department you are dealing with. Search for your county's name plus “property appraiser.” Then confirm by asking the department itself before you file anything.

SECOND: THE ORDER THESE OFFICES COME IN

On a rural Florida lot the building department is **not** the first office you visit. Two approvals are prerequisites to the building permit itself, so filing in the wrong order costs you months.

The filing order on a rural lot

	Office / approval	Why it sits here	Cite
1	Septic construction permit	If the lot is on septic, no building or plumbing permit may issue without it. The site evaluation behind it has to be performed by a qualified professional and is valid for the life of the permit — start here.	s. 381.0065(4)

The filing order on a rural lot

	Office / approval	Why it sits here	Cite
2	Well construction permit	From your water management district, if you are not on a public water system. Separate program, separate office from septic — do not assume one visit covers both.	Rule 62-532.400
3	CCCL permit, if you are seaward of the line	A separate state permit from the Department of Environmental Protection, independent of your building permit. Check the line before you buy, not after.	s. 161.053
4	Zoning and access	Zoning or land-use verification, address assignment, and a driveway or access permit — from the county, or from the Department of Transportation if you connect to a state road.	local; s. 335.182
5	Building permit	With the owner appearing in person to sign, the disclosure statement, and the product approval schedule (FL.1, FL.2).	s. 489.103(7)(c)
6	Notice of Commencement	Recorded at the clerk of the circuit court before work starts, posted at the site, copy filed with the building department before the first inspection (FL.3).	ss. 713.13, 713.135

SEPTIC: THE ONE ANSWER THAT CHANGED, AND IS STILL CHANGING

Almost every Florida guide in print says the **Department of Health** regulates septic systems. That has not been true since the Clean Waterways Act moved the onsite sewage program to the **Department of Environmental Protection**, effective 1 July 2021 (ch. 2020-150, Laws of Florida). But the correction most people then make is also wrong, because the transfer is being implemented **county by county** and is not finished.

Where you actually file, as of September 2026

In these 17 counties, the Department of Environmental Protection issues the permit directly: Bay, Calhoun, Escambia, Franklin, Gadsden, Gulf, Holmes, Jackson, Jefferson, Leon, Liberty, Marion, Okaloosa, Santa Rosa, Wakulla, Walton and Washington.

In the other 50 counties — which is every major metro, including Miami-Dade, Broward, Palm Beach, Orange, Hillsborough and Duval — you file with the Environmental Health program of your local county health department, which administers the program under the Department of Environmental Protection's direction.

The Department's own statement is that transition of the remaining counties “will occur depending on legislative approval,” with no published schedule. So **check the list before you file**: floridadep.gov/water/onsite-sewage, then the permitting FAQ. Your county may have moved since this kit was printed.

Two more things worth knowing before you call. The rule chapter was renumbered in the same move, from **64E-6** to **62-6, F.A.C.** — county forms, contractor paperwork and older articles still say 64E-6, and they mean the same rules. And you **may install your own septic system**: a property owner “who personally performs construction, maintenance, or repairs to a system serving his or her own owner-occupied single-family residence is exempt from registration requirements... but is subject to all permitting requirements” (s. 381.0065(4), Fla. Stat.). Note the limits — personally, own, owner-occupied, single-family — and note that the **site evaluation for a new system still cannot be self-performed**: it takes a Florida licensed engineer with soils training, department personnel, a Master Septic Tank Contractor, a certified professional soil scientist, or a person certified under s. 381.0101.

WELLS: THE FIVE WATER MANAGEMENT DISTRICTS

Who issues your well permit

District	Coverage	Where / rule
Northwest Florida	The 16 westernmost counties: Bay, Calhoun, Escambia, Franklin, Gadsden, Gulf, Holmes, Jackson, Leon, Liberty, Okaloosa, Santa Rosa, Wakulla, Walton, Washington and western Jefferson	nwfwater.com Rule 40A-3
Suwannee River	North-central Florida, the Suwannee River basin. Check the district's own map for your county	srwmd.org Rule 40B-3
St. Johns River	18 counties in northeast and east-central Florida. Check the district's own map for your county	sjrwmd.com Rule 40C-3
Southwest Florida	West-central Florida, the Tampa Bay region and inland. Check the district's own map for your county	swfwmd.state.fl.us Rule 40D-3
South Florida	Broward, Collier, Glades, Hendry, Lee, Martin, Miami-Dade, Monroe, Palm Beach and St. Lucie entirely, plus parts of Charlotte, Highlands, Okeechobee, Orange, Osceola and Polk	sfwmd.gov Rule 40E-3

County lists are as published by the districts themselves. Two districts do not publish a plain county list on their landing pages, so this kit does not invent one — use the district's map tool. A permit is required before construction, repair or abandonment of any water well, and the application may be made by the owner or by the well contractor on the owner's behalf (Rule 62-532.400(1), F.A.C.).

Can you drill your own well? Almost certainly not the one you want

There is a real exemption, and it is narrower than it sounds. Section 373.326(2), Fla. Stat. lets an unlicensed person construct “a well that is 2 inches or under in diameter, on the person's own or leased property, intended for use only in a single-family house which is his or her residence.” Two inches or under is a driven well point — not the four- to six-inch cased well with a submersible pump that a modern household water supply needs. For that you will hire a licensed water well contractor. And the exemption is from the *contractor license* only: the district permit is still required either way.

THE STATEWIDE OFFICES AND LOOKUPS

Every statewide lookup this kit refers to

What you need	Who has it	Where
Verify a contractor's license	Dept. of Business and Professional Regulation	myfloridalicense.com
Look up a product's FL approval number	Florida Building Commission product search	floridabuilding.org/pr/pr_app_srch.aspx
Read the building code, free	Florida Building Commission	floridabuilding.org
Your design wind speed	ASCE 7 Hazard Tool	ascehazardtool.org
Septic permitting, and which office has your county	Dept. of Environmental Protection, Onsite Sewage Program	floridadep.gov/water/onsite-sewage
Your county health department (septic, in 50 counties)	Florida Department of Health	floridahealth.gov/all-county-locations.html
Coastal construction control line permit and map	Dept. of Environmental Protection	floridadep.gov/rcp/coastal-construction-control-line
Your flood zone and base flood elevation	FEMA Map Service Center	msc.fema.gov
Record the Notice of Commencement	Clerk of the circuit court, your county	search your county plus “clerk of court official records”
Read a statute cited in this kit	The Florida Senate	flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes
Read a rule cited in this kit	Florida Administrative Code	flrules.org

Every address above returned a live page in September 2026. This kit prints no phone numbers: they change faster than anything else on a government page, and every office above can be reached from its own site.

COUNTY BUILDING DEPARTMENTS

A note on what this page does and does not give you. Deep links into county permitting pages are the least durable thing a printed kit can carry — when the addresses below were tested, roughly a third of the obvious permitting URLs were dead or silently redirected to an unrelated page, because several counties use numeric page addresses that get reassigned. So this kit prints each county's **main site**, which is stable, and leaves you one search away from a current permitting page. Search the county site for “building permit.”

County main sites — search each for “building permit”

County	Website	County	Website
Alachua	alachuacounty.us	Martin	martin.fl.us
Bay	baycountyfl.gov	Miami-Dade *	miamidade.gov
Brevard	brevardfl.gov	Monroe	monroecounty-fl.gov
Broward *	broward.org	Okaloosa	myokaloosa.com
Charlotte	charlottecountyfl.gov	Orange	orangecountyfl.net
Citrus	citruscounty.gov	Osceola	osceola.org
Clay	claycountygov.com	Palm Beach	discover.pbc.gov
Collier	collier.gov	Pasco	pascocountyfl.gov
Duval / Jacksonville	jacksonville.gov	Pinellas	pinellas.gov
Escambia	myescambia.com	Polk	polkfl.gov
Hernando	hernandocounty.us	St. Johns	sjcfl.us
Hillsborough	hcfl.gov	St. Lucie	stlucieco.gov
Lake	lakecountyfl.gov	Santa Rosa	santarosa.fl.gov
Lee	leegov.com	Sarasota	scgov.net
Leon	leoncountyfl.gov	Seminole	seminolecountyfl.gov
Manatee	mymanatee.org	Volusia	volusia.org
Marion	marionfl.org		

* Broward and Miami-Dade are the High-Velocity Hurricane Zone — expect the Miami-Dade Notice of Acceptance vocabulary and the HVHZ Uniform Permit Application there (FL.2). Each address above responded when tested in September 2026. If your parcel is inside a city, the city's own building department may be the one that permits it — settle that first, using the property appraiser.

WHAT I CONFIRMED

Fill this in as you confirm each office. The point of the page is that you spoke to somebody and wrote down what they said, with a date — which is worth more than any printed directory when a question comes up eight months from now.

My offices

	Item	Date	Notes / what they told me
☐	Building department — county or city? Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____		
☐	Septic — DEP directly, or county health department? Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Permit no.: _____ Spoke with: _____		
☐	Well — water management district District: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Clerk of court — for recording the Notice of Commencement Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Floodplain administrator — flood zone, BFE, freeboard, elevation certificate checkpoints Zone: _____ BFE: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Zoning — setbacks, land use, address assignment Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Driveway / access — county road or state road? Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		
☐	Utility — power, and water if not on a well Office: _____ Confirmed: _____		

My offices

	Item	Date	Notes / what they told me
☐	CCCL — only if seaward of the coastal construction control line Confirmed: _____		

SOURCES

Sources — every Florida claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Counties and municipalities both issue building permits in Florida	s. 713.135(8)
A septic construction permit is a prerequisite to the building or plumbing permit, and final installation approval a prerequisite to occupancy	s. 381.0065(4)
The onsite sewage program transferred from the Department of Health to the Department of Environmental Protection effective 1 July 2021	ch. 2020-150, Laws of Florida
The transfer is phased; DEP issues directly in 17 counties and county health departments administer the rest	Dept. of Environmental Protection, onsite sewage permitting FAQ
Rule chapter 62-6, F.A.C., formerly 64E-6	Rule 62-6, F.A.C., history notes
An owner personally performing work on their own owner-occupied single-family residence is exempt from septic contractor registration but not from permitting	s. 381.0065(4)
The site evaluation for a new system must be performed by one of five named qualified persons	Rule 62-6.004(3), F.A.C.
A permit is required before constructing, repairing or abandoning a water well, applied for by the owner or the contractor	Rule 62-532.400(1), F.A.C.
Water well contractors are licensed by the water management districts	s. 373.323
An owner may construct a well 2 inches or under in diameter on their own property for their own single-family residence without a contractor license	s. 373.326(2)
A separate Department of Environmental Protection permit is required to construct seaward of the coastal construction control line	s. 161.053; Rule 62B-33, F.A.C.

Every source cited in this kit is free to read. A **Fla. Stat.** section is at **flsenate.gov** → Laws → Florida Statutes, or go straight to the section by typing the year and number into the address bar — **flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2024/489.103** — which is faster than the search box (chapters used here: **489** contracting, **553** the building code, **713** construction liens, **161** coastal, **373** water). A rule cited as **F.A.C.** is at **flrules.org** → Search → by rule number. The building code itself is at **floridabuilding.org** → Codes, free to read online without an account. **One warning when you check a number:** flsenate.gov keeps every past year's statutes at a nearly identical address, so a search result can hand you a repealed version — check that the year in the URL is the current one before you rely on the text. All text here was read at those sources, September 2026.